

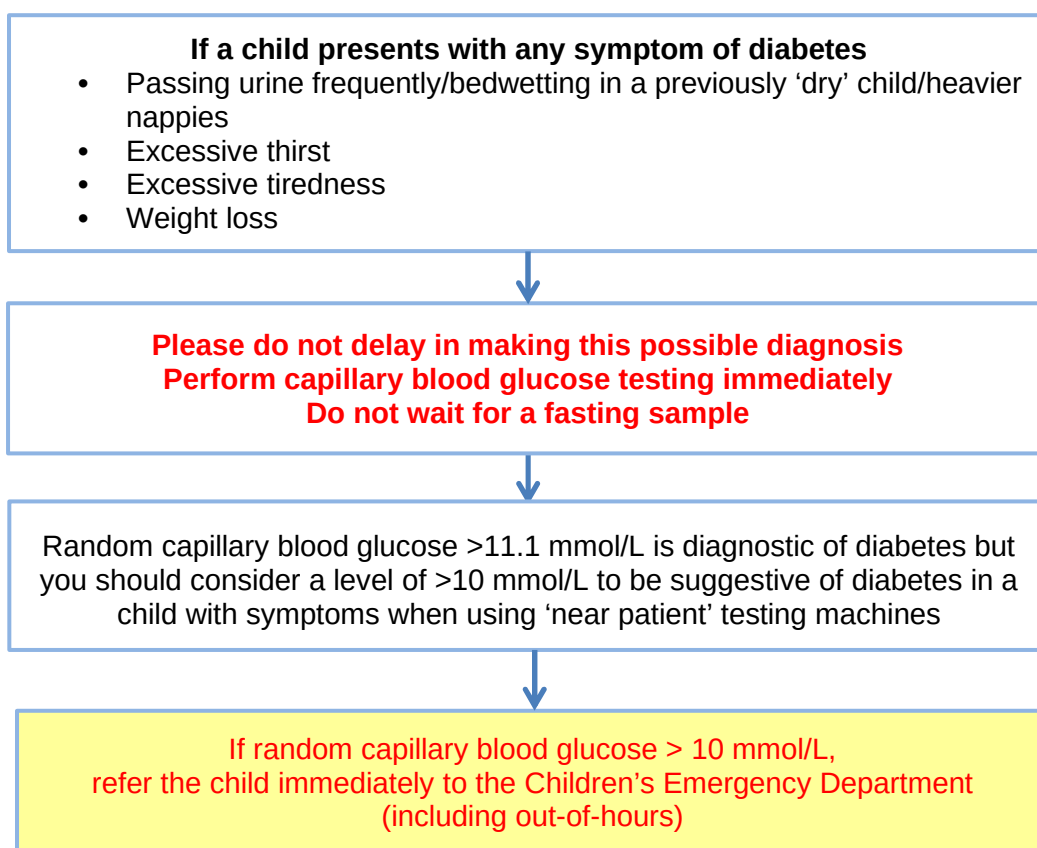
Derbyshire Shared Care Pathology Guidelines

Diagnosis of Diabetes Mellitus in children under 16 years

The majority (97%) of children locally have Type 1 rather than Type 2 diabetes, so symptoms of polyuria, polydipsia and weight loss should alert to the possibility of Type 1 diabetes mellitus.

Please remember 4 T's:

Toilet, Thirsty, Thinner, Tired
(Diabetes UK, 2015)



There is a risk of Diabetic Ketoacidosis in children with Type 1 diabetes (approximately 25% of newly diagnosed children in the UK) and they may deteriorate rapidly, with an unpredictable risk of cerebral oedema.

Refer all children with suspected diabetes mellitus immediately as below **with a referral letter**. Relevant family or social history is helpful. Further investigation will be planned and if diabetes is confirmed, insulin and education will be started that day.

RDH: Children's Emergency Department (01332 785572)

CRH: Either call switchboard (01246 277271) and ask for the paediatric admitting team
OR call Nightingale ward (01246 512324 or 01246 512328) & ask for Charge Nurse

QHB: Either call switchboard (01283 566333) and ask for the paediatric registrar
OR call ward 1 (01283 593233 or 01283 594631) & ask for Nurse in charge.
You will be advised to send the child/young person to QHB A&E.

Reference:

NICE guidance NG18 (Aug 2015) states:

'Refer children and young people with suspected type 1 diabetes immediately (on the same day) to a multidisciplinary paediatric diabetes team with the competencies needed to confirm diagnosis and to provide immediate care.'

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Reviewed by:	Date:	Expiry date:
Dr T Tinklin, Dr P Blackwell, Mrs H Seddon	Dec 2015	31 st Dec 2017
Dr T Tinklin, Dr P Blackwell, Mrs H Seddon	Jan 2018	31 st Jan 2020
Dr T Tinklin, Dr K Kumar, Dr P Blackwell, Mrs H Seddon	June 2020	30 th June 2022
Dr T Tinklin, Dr K Kumar, Dr J Smith, Dr P Blackwell, Mrs H Seddon, Dr R Mathew	Oct 2022	31 st Oct 2024
Dr T Tinklin, Dr K Kumar, Dr J Smith, Dr P Blackwell, Mrs H Seddon, Dr R Mathew	Oct 2022	31 st August 2025
Dr J Smith, Dr R Lloyd-Nash, Dr R Matthew, Dr P Blackwell, Ms S Knowles	February 2025	28 th February 2027